NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 2 • 1569–1588

Challenges to Elizabeth at Home and Abroad, 1569–88



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588)

WOBURN ABBEY COLLECTION • BEDFORDSHIRE • WA-INV-042

Key topic 2: Challenges to Elizabeth at home and abroad, 1569–88	
1 Plots and revolts at home	• The reasons for, and significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70. • The features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton and Babington plots. Walsingham and the use of spies. • The reasons for, and significance of, Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.
2 Relations with Spain	• Political, religious and commercial rivalry. • The significance of privateering and the activities of Drake.
3 Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	• Reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain: English direct involvement in the Netherlands and the actions of Robert Dudley. • Drake and the raid on Cadiz: 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard'.
4 The Armada	• Spanish invasion plans. Key events of the Spanish Armada. • The reasons for the English victory.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

NOV 1569 • Revolt of the Northern Earls

Key Topic 2.1

Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland march on Durham Cathedral, tear up English bibles, and restore the Latin Mass with 4,600 men. Royal troops march north; the rebellion collapses and Elizabeth executes 450 rebels to crush northern disobedience.

FEB 1570 • Papal Bull *Regnans in Excelsis*

Key Topic 2.1

Pope Pius V issues a papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth, declaring her a 'pretended queen' and heretic. Crucially, the Pope releases all Catholic subjects from their oath of allegiance, making it a sacred Catholic duty to overthrow the Queen.

1571–1583 • The Ridolfi and Throckmorton Plots

Key Topic 2.1

Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi plans a Spanish invasion by the Duke of Alba to marry Mary to the Duke of Norfolk. In 1583, French Catholic Francis Throckmorton coordinates a planned invasion backed by Spain and the Pope. Walsingham uncovers both.

"1569: The Northern Earls marched with Catholic banners; Elizabeth responded with 450 executions."

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

AUG 1585 • The Treaty of Nonsuch & Open War with Spain

Key Topic 2.3

Following the assassination of Dutch Protestant leader William of Orange, Elizabeth signs the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels, agreeing to send 7,400 troops under Robert Dudley. This ends decades of cold war and triggers open military conflict with Spain.

1586–FEB 1587 • The Babington Plot & Execution of Mary Stuart

Key Topic 2.1

Anthony Babington sends coded letters in beer barrels to Mary Stuart agreeing to assassinate Elizabeth. Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes intercepts Mary's endorsement. Mary is convicted of high treason and beheaded at Fotheringhay Castle on 8 Feb 1587.

APR 1587–AUG 1588 • Drake at Cadiz & Defeat of the Spanish Armada

Key Topic 2.4

Drake raids Cadiz harbour, destroying 30 Spanish ships ('singeing the King's beard') and delaying the Armada by a year. In July 1588, 130 Spanish ships enter the Channel. English fireships break their formation at Calais; Gravelines artillery seals English victory.

Why did every Catholic plot to assassinate Elizabeth end in catastrophic failure?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 NOV 1569–JAN 1570
The Revolt of the Northern Earls
- Latin Mass at Durham Cathedral
- Spanish Troops Fail to Land
- Four Hundred and Fifty Executions

Why did the Northern Earls fail to overthrow Elizabeth despite capturing Durham Cathedral?

2 1570–1571
Papal Bull & The Ridolfi Plot
- Regnans in Excelsis Excommunication
- Italian Banker Roberto Ridolfi Courier
- Norfolk Beheaded on Tower Hill

How did the 1570 Papal Bull transform the legal and political danger facing English Catholics?

3 1583–1584
The Throckmorton Plot & Bond of Association
- French Duke of Guise Invasion Plan
- Philip II Provides 200,000 Ducats
- Bond of Association Traitor Oath

Why did the discovery of the Throckmorton Plot lead to harsher anti-Catholic measures?

4 1586
The Babington Plot & Walsingham's Spies
- Letters in Waterproof Beer Barrels
- Phelippes Decodes Gallows Cipher
- Explicit Approval of Regicide

How did Walsingham use espionage and deciphered correspondence to trap Mary Stuart?

5 FEB 1587
The Execution of Mary, Queen of Scots
- Act for the Queen's Safety Trial
- Fotheringhay Castle Great Hall Block
- Divine Right Monarchical Martyrdom

Why was Elizabeth so reluctant to execute Mary Queen of Scots despite proven treason?

"Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes decoded the beer barrel letters: detail matters!"

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY | Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS | Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS | Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Ridolfi Plot (1571).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the beer barrel with hidden cipher letters and the execution block at Fotheringhay.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q2) ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587.

You may use in your answer: • The Babington Plot (1586) • Walsingham's spy network *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: DIRECT COMPLICITY IN BABINGTON PLOT POINT 1

Explain that intercepted beer-barrel letters explicitly showed Mary endorsing Anthony Babington's plot to assassinate Elizabeth; Phelippes decoded Mary's letter containing the postmark gallows sign.

2. CAUSE 2: WALSINGHAM & PARLIAMENTARY PRESSURE POINT 2

Explain that the 1584 Bond of Association legally obligated privy councillors to execute anyone involved in assassination plots; Parliament and Cecil relentlessly lobbied Elizabeth to sign the death warrant.

3. CAUSE 3: ESCALATING SPANISH WAR THREAT POINT 3

Explain that by 1586 England was at open war with Spain following the Treaty of Nonsuch; keeping Mary alive created an immediate rallying figure for an imminent Spanish invasion of England.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Extended writing: explain how each domestic Catholic plot had direct foreign Spanish backing."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Was war between England and Spain inevitable from the moment Elizabeth took the throne?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 **1570–1577**

Political and Religious Rivalry with Spain

- Antwerp Deep-Water Ports Threat
- William of Orange Protestant Rebellion
- Funding Sea Beggars Privateers

Why did Spanish control of the Netherlands threaten English trade and security?

2 **1570–1579**

Commercial Rivalry in the New World

- Spanish Monopoly on American Bullion
- Nombre de Dios Mule Train Ambush
- Queen Licences Legal Piracy

Why did English privateering in the Caribbean inflame diplomatic tensions with Spain?

3 **1577–1580**

Drake's Circumnavigation

- Cacafuego Surrenders £140,000 Treasure
- Uncharted Pacific Raids on Peru
- Golden Hind Knighthood Defiance

Why did Drake's circumnavigation represent a direct challenge to the Spanish Empire?

4 **1581–1584**

Escalation & Elizabeth's Defiance

- Philip II Inherits Portuguese Crown
- Assassination of William of Orange
- French Catholic Guise League Accord

How did events in Europe between 1580 and 1584 increase the threat of a Spanish invasion?

5 **1584–1585**

The Treaties of Joinville & Nonsuch

- Secret Treaty of Joinville (Dec 1584)
- 7,400 English Troops under Dudley
- Direct Military Confrontation Declared

Why did the Treaty of Nonsuch mark the point of no return for war between England and Spain?

"Privateers were legal pirates with a royal license: Drake took Spanish silver for England's glory."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] MEDIUM FREQUENCY

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of commercial rivalry between England and Spain in the New World.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel November 2021 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Drake's raid on the Cacafuego (1579).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS

Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of English privateering against Spanish treasure fleets.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 3). In Milestone 3, sketch Drake's ship the *Golden Hind* and the Spanish silver bars.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2023 (Q3A) | **CORE EXAM FOCUS** | **Score: [/ 20]**

'Commercial rivalry in the Americas was the main cause of worsening relations between England and Spain between 1569 and 1585.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Francis Drake's privateering • Religious conflict ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

1. CRITERIA 1: COMMERCIAL RIVALRY & DRAKE — POINT 1	2. CRITERIA 2: RELIGIOUS ANTAGONISM — POINT 2	3. CRITERIA 3: THE STRATEGIC NETHERLANDS CRISIS — POINT 3
Explain how Drake's raids in the West Indies and Pacific humiliated Philip II; by knighting Drake in 1581 and funding privateers, Elizabeth demonstrated state sponsorship of piracy against Spanish bullion.	Explain that Philip viewed himself as the secular sword of the Catholic Counter-Reformation; the 1570 papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth and Philip's backing of plots (Ridolfi, Throckmorton) made holy war inevitable.	Explain that Spain's military brutality in the Netherlands (Alba and Parma) threatened England's chief wool export market; Spanish control of Channel ports was an intolerable direct invasion threat.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Sustained response: explain how privateering transformed commercial rivalry into formal war."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Did English intervention in the Netherlands or Drake's raid on Cadiz make the Armada inevitable?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 DEC 1585–1586

Dudley's Campaign in the Netherlands

- Governor-General Title Angers Elizabeth
- Underfunded & Deserting English Troops
- Prevents Parma Capturing Deep Ports

Why did Dudley's campaign in the Netherlands struggle to achieve decisive military success?

2 1586–1587

Military Setbacks: Zutphen & Deventer

- Sir Philip Sidney Killed at Zutphen
- Stanley & Yorke Betray Dutch Forts
- Dutch Council of State Distrust

How did English betrayals and command disputes damage relations with the Dutch rebels?

3 APRIL 1587

Drake's Raid on Cadiz

- Thirty Spanish Warships Destroyed
- 'Singeing the King of Spain's Beard'
- Postpones Armada by Twelve Months

How did Drake's tactical boldness at Cadiz disrupt the Spanish invasion timetable?

4 1587–1588

Impact of the Cadiz Raid

- Seasoned Barrel Staves Incinerated
- Santa Cruz Dies; Medina Sidonia Inexperienced
- Rotting Food & Leaking Water Casks

Why were logistical damage and command changes fatal to the Spanish invasion plan?

5 MAY–JULY 1588

The Armada Sets Sail

- 130 Ships & 30,000 Men Sail
- Parma Lacks Deep-Water Harbor in Shallows
- Unreliable 48-Hour Message Relay

What strategic flaws made Philip II's plan to link the fleet with Parma extremely risky?

"The Netherlands was England's front door: Elizabeth could not allow Parma to control Dutch deep-water ports."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

CORE SPECIFICATION FOCUS | Edexcel June 2022 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Not examined since 2019) | Edexcel June 2019 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS | Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of the Treaty of Joinville (1584).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 4). In Milestone 4, sketch the Dutch Protestant rebel banner and the Treaty of Nonsuch seal.

← Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q2) | ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST | Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels in 1585.

You may use in your answer: • The assassination of William of Orange • The Treaty of Joinville *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: ASSASSINATION OF WILLIAM OF ORANGE POINT 1

Explain that the murder of William the Silent in July 1584 left the Dutch rebellion leaderless and facing total collapse; if the Dutch fell, Parma's veteran Spanish army would turn directly on England.

2. CAUSE 2: THE TREATY OF JOINVILLE & ISOLATION POINT 2

Explain that in Dec 1584 Spain and France signed the Treaty of Joinville, uniting the two Catholic superpowers; England faced total diplomatic encirclement and could no longer play France off against Spain.

3. CAUSE 3: STRATEGIC CONTROL OF CHANNEL PORTS POINT 3

Explain that deep-water Dutch ports like Antwerp, Flushing, and Brill lay directly opposite the Thames estuary; Elizabeth had to secure these ports to prevent an invasion springboard into southern England.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

Why did the Spanish Armada fail: superior English tactics or disastrous Spanish planning?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • 5 CAUSAL MILESTONES

PUPIL NOTE-TAKING ZONE • *Answer each milestone prompt using evidence from teacher exposition*

1 JULY 1588

Channel Battles: Plymouth to Isle of Wight

- Seven-Mile Crescent Defensive Line
- Long-Range Culverin Duel Beyond Boarding
- Prevented Landing on Isle of Wight

Why were English ships unable to break the Armada's crescent formation in open Channel water?

2 7–8 AUG 1588

Calais Roads & The Fireships

- Eight Pitch-Soaked Vessels at Midnight
- Panic-Stricken Spanish Ships Cut Anchors
- Shattered Crescent Never Reforms

Why did the English use of fireships at Calais prove the decisive turning point of the campaign?

3 8 AUG 1588

The Battle of Gravelines

- Hawkins' Low Race-Built Galleons
- Rapid-Fire Broadside Gunnery Close Range
- Three Galleons Sunk & Fleet Scattered

How did English ship design and gunnery tactics defeat Spanish warships at Gravelines?

4 AUG–SEPT 1588

The Winds & Atlantic Retreat

- Gale-Force 'Protestant Wind' Drives North
- Missing Anchors on Scottish & Irish Reefs
- Only Sixty-Seven Battered Ships Return

Why did the combination of adverse weather and lost equipment destroy the retreating Armada?

5 1588–1589

Consequences of the English Victory

- Tilbury Speech: 'Heart & Stomach of a King'
- 'God Blew and They Were Scattered' Medals
- English Naval Superpower Prestige Secured

How did the defeat of the Armada transform Elizabeth's reputation at home and abroad?

"The Spanish crescent formation held until eight English fireships drifted into Calais Roads at midnight."

Question 1 Practice: Describe Three Key Features [3 × 2 marks • 9 mins]

Total Score: [/ 6]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

MEDIUM FREQUENCY | Edexcel November 2020 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Spanish invasion plan of 1588.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD FOCUS | Edexcel June 2024 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the English fireship attack at Calais (7 August 1588).

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

• QUESTION 1(C): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

HIGH-YIELD SPECIFICATION FOCUS | Edexcel Specification Focus

Describe one key feature of English naval tactics during the Armada campaign.

Target: AO1 [2 marks] • Point (State one clear, valid historical feature) • Detail (Support with precise factual context).
Sentence Stems: *One key feature was that... • Specifically, this was evident when...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch the blazing fireships drifting into Calais Roads and the shattered Spanish galleon.

← Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q3B) | ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST | Score: [/ 20]

'The English defeated the Spanish Armada mainly because of superior English naval tactics and technology.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • English fireships at Calais • Spanish planning and leadership *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CRITERIA 1: ENGLISH TACTICS & SHIP DESIGN — POINT 1	2. CRITERIA 2: FLAWED SPANISH INVASION PLANNING — POINT 2	3. CRITERIA 3: ADVERSE WEATHER & THE "PROTESTANT WIND" — POINT 3
Explain how Hawkins' race-built galleons out-maneuvered clumsy Spanish carracks, using long-range culverins on four-wheeled truck carriages to reload and fire broadsides rapidly at Gravelines.	Explain that Philip II's plan was fatally flawed: Parma controlled no deep-water port in the Netherlands, meaning communication took 48 hours by horse and barges could not escape Dutch flyboat blockades.	Explain that south-westerly gales drove the scattered Spanish fleet into the hazardous North Sea; lacking anchors lost at Calais, dozens of galleons were wrecked on the jagged rocks of Scotland and Ireland.

Task: *Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):*

"Independent practice: weigh fireship chaos against Medina Sidonia's lack of deep-water ports."

MARGIN	*[Extended Writing Continued • Paragraph 2/3 & Final Sustained Conclusion]*

⭐ GRADE 9 MASTERCLASS: CAUSATION ESSAY • KEY TOPIC 2

EDEXCEL JUNE 2021 · PAPER 2 | **LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR • 12/12 MARKS**

OFFICIAL EXAM QUESTION • QUESTION 2 [12 MARKS • 18 MINS] — AO1 (6m Knowledge & Understanding) + AO2 (6m Causation & Analysis)

Explain why the Catholic threat to Elizabeth increased in the years 1569–85.

You may use in your answer:	• Papal Bull Regnans in Excelsis (1570)	• Throckmorton Plot (1583)	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACTIVE MODEL ANNOTATION PROTOCOL: 🟠 1. Highlight 3 historical facts / statistics | 🔵 2. Underline 3 causal connective links | 🟢 3. Circle where own knowledge beyond stimulus begins

CONTINUOUS PROSE LEVEL 4 EXEMPLAR RESPONSE (FULL MARKS • 12/12)

Notice: Every paragraph opens with a factor, gives precise evidence, and ends with a direct causal link.

PARAGRAPH 1 • STIMULUS 1 A primary reason why the Catholic threat increased was Pope Pius V's papal bull 'Regnans in Excelsis' in 1570. By excommunicating Elizabeth as a heretic and formally declaring her deposed, the Pope released English Catholics from their feudal oaths of allegiance, ordering them to disobey her royal commands. This transformed English Catholics from moderate religious dissenters into active traitors, providing international theological justification for domestic rebellion and foreign invasion. It also destroyed Elizabeth's policy of religious toleration, forcing the government to treat every Catholic as a potential assassin.

PARAGRAPH 2 • STIMULUS 2 Furthermore, the threat deepened because domestic Catholic unrest evolved into coordinated international conspiracies to overthrow the regime, as demonstrated by the 1583 Throckmorton Plot. Led by Francis Throckmorton, the conspiracy planned for a French Catholic invasion force led by the Duke of Guise, funded by Philip II of Spain and the Pope, to liberate Mary, Queen of Scots and depose Elizabeth. Uncovered by Sir Francis Walsingham's intelligence service, the plot confirmed that foreign Catholic superpowers were actively collaborating to launch a full-scale invasion of England, provoking nationwide alarm and leading directly to the 1584 Bond of Association.

PARAGRAPH 3 • OWN KNOWLEDGE Beyond the stimulus, the threat escalated dramatically due to the covert arrival of seminary priests and Jesuits trained in continental Europe. Following William Allen's establishment of the English College at Douai in 1568, and the arrival of Jesuits like Edmund Campion in 1580, these trained missionaries travelled secretly through England administering Latin sacraments and sustaining Catholic defiance in secret priest holes. Although priests claimed purely spiritual motives, the Privy Council viewed them as foreign fifth-columnists preparing the populace for Spanish invasion. This prompted Parliament to enact draconian treason laws in 1581 and 1585, making conversion to Catholicism punishable by death.

EXAMINER COMPARISON • WHY MOST PUPILS DROP MARKS ON QUESTION 2

⚠️ **The Level 2 Narrative Trap (4–6 / 12 Marks):**
Pupils list Catholic plots chronologically: "First the Northern Earls rebelled in 1569. Then the Pope issued a bull. Then Ridolfi plotted with Norfolk, and later Throckmorton planned an invasion." This narrates events without explaining HOW the threat mutated from local discontent into global warfare.

🎯 **The Level 4 Analytical Standard (10–12 / 12 Marks):**
Traces the systematic escalation of threat across three analytical tiers: ideological warfare (papal bull), foreign military coordination (Spanish-backed invasion plots), and clandestine religious subversion (Jesuit missions). Directly explains why each development forced the Crown to adopt harsher counter-measures.

✍️ **PUPIL ACTION • DRAFT YOUR OWN ANALYTICAL CONCLUSION [2 SENTENCES]**

State which factor was the most dangerous catalyst in escalating the Catholic threat and justify your choice in 2 sentences:

"Armada Tactics: High Spanish castles for boarding vs low English race-built galleons for gunnery."

UNSEEN SYNOPTIC EXAM PRACTICE • KEY TOPIC 2

PEARSON EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 · PAPER 2 | **Timed Condition: 18 Mins** | **Score: [/ 12]**

QUESTION 2 • EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS • AO1 (6M) + AO2 (6M)] — Write 3 analytical paragraphs with sustained causal links to the stem

Explain why relations between England and Spain worsened between 1569 and 1585.

You may use in your answer: • Francis Drake's privateering • The Netherlands ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

PARAGRAPH 1 (STIMULUS 1) PLAN

Factor 1 · Drake's Privateering: Raids on Nombre de Dios (1572) and Cacafuego (£140,000 in silver); Drake circumnavigates (1577–80); Elizabeth knights him at Deptford in 1581, enraging Philip II.

PARAGRAPH 2 (STIMULUS 2) PLAN

Factor 2 · The Netherlands Crisis: Brutal Spanish repression under Duke of Alba; 1576 Spanish Fury at Antwerp; 1584 William the Silent murdered; 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch sends 7,400 English troops.

PARAGRAPH 3 (OWN KNOWLEDGE) CRUCIAL

Factor 3 · Own Knowledge (Crucial): Religious & Dynastic Conspiracies; Philip II and Spanish Ambassador Mendoza actively funded the 1571 Ridolfi and 1583 Throckmorton plots; 1584 Treaty of Joinville united France and Spain against England.

MARGIN	*[Begin your 3-paragraph timed causation response here...]*

Level Descriptors:	[ ] L1 (1–3m): Basic / Descriptive	[ ] L2 (4–6m): Simple Explanation	[ ] L3 (7–9m): Developed Analysis	[ ] L4 (10–12m): Sustained Causal Judgement	**Final Mark: [/ 12]**

"The Protestant Wind: God blew and they were scattered, but Hawkins' ship design won the battle."

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 2.1 & 2.2

Classroom Protocol: Complete 5–10 questions as a Do Now bell-ringer at the start of each lesson, or quiz yourself across the term. Tick the review checkboxes (**R1, R2, R3**) after each spaced retrieval attempt.

ENQUIRY 2.1: PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME [/ 10]

1. Which two northern Catholic earls led the 1569 rebellion? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

2. Which Catholic cathedral did the Northern Earls seize to celebrate the Latin Mass? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

3. What papal bull excommunicated Elizabeth I in 1570? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

4. Which English duke was executed in 1572 for his role in the Ridolfi Plot? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

5. Who was Queen Elizabeth's Spymaster General from 1573? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

6. How did plotters smuggle coded messages to Mary Stuart during the Babington Plot? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

7. What skilled cryptographer decoded Mary Stuart's letters for Walsingham? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

8. What 1584 document pledged to execute anyone who attempted to assassinate Elizabeth? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

9. In which castle was Mary, Queen of Scots beheaded on 8 February 1587? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

10. Approximately how many northern rebels did Elizabeth execute after the 1569 revolt? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

ENQUIRY 2.2: RELATIONS WITH SPAIN [/ 10]

11. Which Spanish king had previously been married to Elizabeth's sister Mary I? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

12. What religion was Philip II, positioning himself as champion of the Counter-Reformation? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

13. What Spanish monopoly prohibited English merchants from trading in the Americas? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

14. What term describes state-licensed sea captains who raided enemy merchant ships? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

15. Which English privateer became the first to circumnavigate the globe (1577–80)? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

16. What famous Spanish treasure ship was captured by Drake off Ecuador in 1579? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

17. How much silver and treasure did Drake capture from the *Cacafuego*? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

18. Where did Elizabeth publicly knight Francis Drake in 1581? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

19. Why was Philip II enraged by Elizabeth knighting Francis Drake? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

20. What Dutch territory revolted against Philip II's rule in 1566? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

"Grade 9 Essay: Don't just describe the fireships — explain why panic broke the defensive formation."

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 2.3 & 2.4

Spaced Retention Target: Test yourself on previous weeks' topics before starting a new enquiry. Frequent low-stakes retrieval prevents forgetting and secures Level 4 factual precision.

ENQUIRY 2.3: OUTBREAK OF WAR WITH SPAIN, 1585–88 [/ 10]

21. Which Dutch Protestant leader was assassinated by a Catholic fanatic in 1584? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

22. What treaty between Philip II and the French Catholic League was signed in 1584? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

23. What 1585 treaty committed English troops to fight alongside Dutch rebels? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

24. Who was appointed commander of the 7,400 English soldiers sent to the Netherlands? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

25. What controversial political title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands, outraging Elizabeth? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

26. Which brilliant Spanish general commanded the Army of Flanders in the Netherlands? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

27. In which Spanish harbour did Francis Drake launch a daring surprise raid in April 1587? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

28. How many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour in 36 hours? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

29. What famous phrase described Drake's raid on Cadiz? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

30. What vital naval supplies did Drake destroy at Cadiz that crippled the Armada's food storage? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

ENQUIRY 2.4: THE ARMADA [/ 10]

31. How many ships sailed in the Spanish Armada in May 1588? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

32. Who was appointed Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish Armada by Philip II? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

33. What veteran Spanish army in the Netherlands was the Armada supposed to collect? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

34. Who served as Lord High Admiral commanding the English fleet in 1588? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

35. What naval treasurer revolutionized English galleon design with lower forecastles? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

36. What long-range naval cannon allowed English ships to bombard Spanish galleons from safety? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

37. What defensive formation did the Spanish Armada maintain sailing up the Channel? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

38. What terrifying tactic did the English use at midnight on 7 August off Calais? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

39. What decisive naval battle was fought on 8 August 1588 off the Flemish coast? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

40. What route were the surviving Spanish ships forced to take back to Spain? [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3

QUICK-CHECK ANSWER KEY • KEY TOPIC 2 SYNOPTIC VAULT (QUESTIONS 1–40)

Enquiry 2.1 (Q1–10): 1. The Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland • 2. Durham Cathedral • 3. Regnans in Excelsis • 4. The Duke of Norfolk (Thomas Howard) • 5. Sir Francis Walsingham • 6. Inside the bungs of beer barrels • 7. Thomas Phelippes • 8. The Bond of Association • 9. Fotheringhay Castle • 10. Approximately 450 rebels

Enquiry 2.3 (Q21–30): 21. William of Orange (William the Silent) • 22. The Treaty of Joinville • 23. The Treaty of Nonsuch • 24. Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester • 25. Governor-General of the United Provinces • 26. The Duke of Parma (Alexander Farnese) • 27. Cadiz Harbour • 28. Approximately 30 ships • 29. "Singeing the King of Spain's Beard" • 30. Seasoned oak barrel staves (ruining water and provisions)

Enquiry 2.2 (Q11–20): 11. King Philip II of Spain • 12. Roman Catholic • 13. The trade monopoly on Spanish New World colonies • 14. Privateers • 15. Sir Francis Drake • 16. The *Nuestra Señora de la Concepción* (nicknamed the *Cacafuego*) • 17. Over £140,000 (worth tens of millions today) • 18. On board the *Golden Hind* at Deptford • 19. He viewed Drake as a common pirate and thief of Spanish property • 20. The Netherlands (Spanish Netherlands)

Enquiry 2.4 (Q31–40): 31. 130 ships • 32. The Duke of Medina Sidonia • 33. The Duke of Parma's Army of Flanders (27,000 troops) • 34. Lord Howard of Effingham • 35. Sir John Hawkins • 36. Culverins • 37. The tight Crescent Formation • 38. Eight Hellburners / Fireships • 39. The Battle of Gravelines • 40. North around Scotland and the west coast of Ireland

Rotate booklet 180° to self-mark retrieval drills in green pen

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT • ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

KEY TOPIC 2 ASSESSMENT & HOMEWORK RECORD

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** [ ] **PREDICTED:** [ ] **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

MASTER EXAM PRACTICE & HOMEWORK ASSESSMENT TRACKER • KEY TOPIC 2

#	ENQUIRY & SPECIFICATION TOPIC	PAGE	EXAM PRACTICE QUESTION & FOCUS	HOMEWORK DEADLINE	MARK AWARDED
2.1	ENQUIRY 2.1: PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME Do Now Retrieval (p. 4): [/ 10]	p. 5	**Q1(a) Feature:** the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569) [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q1(b) Feature:** Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q1(c) Feature:** the Ridolfi Plot (1571) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 5	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots was executed in 1587. [12m]		[/ 12]
2.2	ENQUIRY 2.2: RELATIONS WITH SPAIN Do Now Retrieval (p. 8): [/ 10]	p. 9	**Q1(a) Feature:** commercial rivalry between England and Spain in the New World [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q1(b) Feature:** Sir Francis Drake's raid on the Cacafuego (1579) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q1(c) Feature:** English privateering against Spanish treasure fleets [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 9	**Q3 Essay:** 'Commercial rivalry in the Americas was the main cause of worsening... [16m]		[/ 16]
2.3	ENQUIRY 2.3: OUTBREAK OF WAR WITH SPAIN, 1585–88 Do Now Retrieval (p. 12): [/ 10]	p. 13	**Q1(a) Feature:** the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q1(b) Feature:** Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587 [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q1(c) Feature:** the Treaty of Joinville (1584) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 13	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebel... [12m]		[/ 12]
2.4	ENQUIRY 2.4: THE ARMADA Do Now Retrieval (p. 16): [/ 10]	p. 17	**Q1(a) Feature:** the Spanish invasion plan of 1588 [2m]	[___/___]	[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q1(b) Feature:** the English fireship attack at Calais (7 August 1588) [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q1(c) Feature:** English naval tactics during the Armada campaign [2m]		[/ 2]
		p. 17	**Q3 Essay:** 'The English defeated the Spanish Armada mainly because of superior... [16m]		[/ 16]

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ENQUIRY 2.1
Plots and revolts at home
The Revolt of the Northern Earls • 1569

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 2.2
Relations with Spain
Political and religious rivalry between E...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 2.3
Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–...
The Dutch Revolt and English involvemen...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 2.4
The Armada
The Spanish invasion plan and leadership...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: [/ 20] Date: ___/___